Tarka is not a reliable means of knowledge in its own right because it trades on conclusions whose truth has already been established.

Further reading: Ganeri 2001a

Tattva (type of reality; level of existence): metaphysical theories often include schemes of what they claim exists. The most influential is that of the ***Samkhya*** system, which holds that material nature (*prakriti*) is the source of the physical world. From it emerge: intellect (***buddhi***); the ego (***ahamkara***); the ***manas***; the five sensory (***indriya***) and five motor faculties; the five subtle elements of sound, touch, visible form, taste and smell; and the five gross material elements (atmosphere, air, fire, earth and water).

Many traditions accept this framework, but some add supernatural levels of reality that accommodate other worlds or spheres of experience. The Kashmiri ***Shaiva Siddhanta*** cult places the *Shiva-tattva* at the pinnacle. It is followed by the *tattva* of divine power (*Shakti*), the *Sadashiva tattva*, the *Ishvara tattva* and the *Vidya-tattva*. These five are transcendental and contain pure worlds populated by released souls. Next come five *tattvas* applying particularly to souls: limited power of knowledge, limited power of action, passion, time and ethical consequentiality. At this point, the ***Samkhya*** scheme is introduced.

Trairupya-hetu (threefold logical reason): following ***Dignaga***, Buddhist logicians say that, in a valid inference or proof, there must be an inseparable connection (*avinabhava-sambandha*) between the logical reason or proving property (***hetu***) and what is to be proved (***sadhya***). Wherever the reason occurs, there the ***sadhya*** occurs also. The satisfaction of three conditions guarantees this: